

ELECTRIC CARS READY FOR PURCHASE IN INDIA



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Electric vehicles (EVs) are getting popular in India every day, and many people have already taken the green route. Value proposition of EVs lies not only in massive reduction in carbon footprint but also in lower consumption of petrol, diesel, CNG and

other fuels, which also amounts to higher financial savings at a personal level and a brighter future at the ecological scale. However, are EVs really that abundantly available in India? Where can buyers purchase them? What should they know about maintenance? We try to answer these questions in this article.

Purchasing an EV in India

At a global scale EVs are quite popular, but the scenario is a little different in India. EVs are popular here in the form of two- and three-wheelers. Electric buses

are also picking up pace, especially across the states of Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and the north-east. Four-wheelers are still limited in terms of options. The number of EVs in the market is set to rise exponentially by the end of 2020, as many popular automakers have put forward their plans to launch their own EVs.

As of now, players like Mahindra, Tata, Toyota, Lexus, Hyundai and Honda have launched green cars for the Indian market. It is important to note that among these some of Mahindra's cars are pure electric, that is, these can be run only through stored electric charge provided by a battery. Most others are hybrids. Hybrid electric cars depend primarily on fuel (petrol or diesel) but also have a battery pack, which takes over when oil runs out. However, batteries cannot take over as the primary ignition source and, hence, the motive of using of an EV is diluted.

There is another category called plug-in hybrid EVs. These can be driven on battery or on such fuel as petrol or diesel at will. However, the Indian market does not have many such cars yet.

Maxson Lewis, managing director, Magenta Power, says, "Cost of four-wheeler EVs is higher by around twenty to forty per cent as compared to similar cars running on petrol or diesel. While the number of components in EVs is lower, major cost is driven by the battery, which constitutes around 35 per cent of the total cost."

Mahindra has three models of pure